

ORRI INCUBATOR GRANTS- PROPOSAL

SYFERS - Syntropic Framework for Encoding Regenerative Societies

1. OBJECTIVES, NEEDS and APPROACH [Excellence]

1.1 Objectives

Overall aim

To turn Silitânia, an already active rural cooperative and Living Lab in Southern Portugal, where community members and volunteers work daily on regeneration, into a reference site for ORRI-driven, syntropic and regenerative innovation, and to develop a transferable ORRI Tool that enables other rural regions to follow the same path.

Specific objectives

1. **Design and test a Syntropic Living Lab (SLL) governance model** for Silitânia Cooperative that applies ORRI principles (public engagement, gender & minority inclusion, open science, ethics, science education and good governance) to real territorial challenges.
2. **Co-create and implement integrated pilots** across three pillars:
 - ecological regeneration (soil, water, biodiversity, food production);
 - social & relational ecosystem (community governance, inclusion, wellbeing);
 - economic / learning activities (training, micro-enterprises, regenerative tourism) showing how they reinforce each other in one rural site.
3. **Develop one ORRI Tool – the Syntropic Framework for Encoding Regenerative Societies (SYFERS)** that codifies methods, templates and lessons from Silitânia into a practical guide for other rural organisations and municipalities.
4. **Strengthen institutional capacity for ORRI and RRI** within Silitânia Cooperative embedding gender & minority inclusion, open science and participatory decision-making into their permanent practices and strategies.

These objectives are realistic within a 12-month Incubator project and measurable through:

- number and quality of pilots implemented;
- adoption of the governance model and ORRI practices in internal rules;
- completion and external validation of the ORRI Tool;
- documented changes in skills, attitudes and procedures in both partner organisations.

1.2 Needs and proposed approach to address them

Needs

The project is based in **rural Southern Portugal (Castro Marim area)**, a territory facing:

- **Ecological stress:** drought, soil degradation, forest fires and biodiversity loss, aggravated by climate change and historical land use.

- **Socio-economic fragility:** ageing population, seasonal tourism, limited local employment and out-migration of young people.
- **Fragmented initiatives:** environmental, social and economic projects often operate separately, with limited integration or long-term governance.
- **Implementation gap:** EU Green Deal, SDG's and national recovery plans set ambitious goals, but local actors lack concrete, human-scale models to test and adapt.

At the same time, Sulitânia and Quinta da Fornalha already host:

- a **developing food forest and syntropic agroforestry systems;**
- an **emerging co-housing and community structure;**
- **regenerative tourism and small-scale production;**
- a diverse group of community members with strong motivation but limited experience in ORRI methodologies.

The central need is therefore **a structured, participatory and replicable way to connect these strands** into one coherent, regenerative and socially inclusive “micro-infrastructure” that can be documented and shared.

Main potential challenges

1. **Limited experience with ORRI processes**
Local actors are motivated and with high potential but unfamiliar with systematic reflection, multi-stakeholder facilitation, and iterative co-creation.
2. **Cultural and social diversity**
Differences in languages, backgrounds, expectations and capacities may create misunderstandings or uneven participation.
3. **Risk of project overload**
High ambition in a small community can lead to fatigue or confusion about priorities without a clear structure.
4. **Integration across pillars**
Ecological, social and economic activities naturally evolve at different speeds; aligning them requires careful coordination.
5. **Documentation & scaling**
Turning living, intuitive processes into clear, transferable models is complex and requires continuous discipline.
6. **Local-to-global translation**
Creating a framework that is deeply rooted in place while remaining adaptable to other rural regions.

Proposed approach

Our approach is to treat Sulitânia as a **Syntropic Living Lab (SLL)**:

- a **real place** where land, people and systems are interdependent;
- a **quadruple helix environment**, involving citizens/community members, local businesses, municipalities/authorities and knowledge actors;
- a **regenerative micro-infrastructure** that integrates ecological, social and economic flows.

Key features of the approach:

- **Co-creation from within:** community members, workers, volunteers, guests and local partners are involved in diagnosing needs, designing pilots and reflecting on results.
- **Syntropic leadership:** leadership is understood as creating conditions for life to organise itself, rather than controlling people. This means focusing on coherence, clear roles, transparent decision-making and responsibility.
- **ORRI as backbone:** we explicitly use ORRI principles to structure reflection, design and evaluation. The **SYFERS** will be built around the ORRI approach.
- **"Glocal" perspective:** we address local needs in Castro Marim while designing tools, indicators and formats that make it easy for other rural regions to adapt the model.
- **Iterative learning:** pilots are designed in short cycles: observe → prototype → evaluate → adjust, with continuous documentation and open sharing. This prevents project overload.

1.2.1 Inclusion, Gender Equality and Minorities

In syntropic systems, **diversity is a source of order, resilience and intelligence.**

Therefore, for Sulitânia, inclusion is a **core leadership principle**, not an administrative requirement.

Our communities already include people of different genders, ages, cultures, abilities and socio-economic backgrounds. In this project we will:

- **Treat inclusion as a syntropic principle:** ensuring that minority voices (non-binary, LGBTQIA+, migrants, neurodiverse, low-income, elders, youth) are seen, heard and integrated in all decision-making.
- **Ensure balanced participation:** avoiding domination by any single gender or group, and ensuring diverse representation across facilitation, meetings and ORRI events.
- **Respect gender identity and expression:** including the use of chosen pronouns and inclusive communication in English and Portuguese.
- **Make power dynamics discussable:** creating facilitated spaces to address hidden biases related to gender, age, culture or background.
- **Use restorative conflict processes:** focusing on awareness and repair, while ensuring safety and support for anyone who feels marginalised.

In short: inclusion, equality and diversity are living practices that allow syntropy to emerge.

1.2.2 Open Science

We will integrate Open Science practices by:

- **Documenting methods, processes and tools openly** (in English and Portuguese) and sharing them through a dedicated website and/or open repository (e.g. Zenodo or OSF);
- **Publishing the SYFERS as an open ORRI Tool** under a Creative Commons licence, so other regions can adapt it;

- **Collecting and sharing non-sensitive data** (e.g. soil indicators, biodiversity observations, participation metrics, workshop formats) in reusable formats;
- **Involving citizens as co-researchers**, particularly in monitoring ecological indicators, mapping social networks and reflecting on governance
- **Participating in ORRI and REINFORCING knowledge-sharing activities**, contributing our results to the wider community of practice.

2. CHANGES TO BE ACHIEVED [Impact]

Our project aims for **three levels of change**:

2.1 Organisational and ORRI institutional change

For **Sulitânia Cooperative**:

- A **tested SLL governance model** integrating ORRI principles into daily practice (meeting formats, decision-making, conflict resolution, role definition).
- **Established internal procedures** for gender & minority aware, inclusive and participatory processes.
- **Strengthened Open Science culture**, with regular documentation, transparent sharing and citizen involvement.
- **Improved skills and confidence** of staff and community members in facilitation, co-creation, monitoring and evaluation.

These changes will be formalised in updated internal guidelines and governance documents, and monitored through self-assessment at start, mid-term and end of the project.

2.2 Territorial impact (Castro Marim / Southern Portugal)

- A **functioning regenerative micro-infrastructure** in Sulitânia:
 - improved soil and water management;
 - more diverse and productive food systems;
 - better organised shared spaces and community structures;
 - pilots for regenerative micro-businesses (e.g. food forest products, educational programmes, ecotourism activities).
- **Increased engagement of local actors** (citizens, SME's, schools, municipality) in ORRI-style co-creation.
- **Concrete contributions to SDG's** – especially SDG 2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 10, 11, 12, 13, 15, 16 and 17 – by showing how they can be addressed simultaneously in one place.
- **A visible example of a rural region moving from vulnerability to regeneration**, providing hope and practical reference for similar territories in Southern Portugal and beyond.

2.3 Wider societal and knowledge impact

- **SYFERS** – a structured **guide and toolkit** that combines:
 - ORRI principles and tools;
 - syntropic and regenerative design concepts;
 - practical templates and case examples from Sulitânia;

- guidance on gender & minority inclusion, open science and quadruple helix engagement.
- **Transferable learning** for other rural communities, cooperatives, municipalities and SME's who wish to implement ORRI-based living labs.
- **Contribution to European discussions** on how to align Green Deal, SDG's and rural development with real community-led practice.

3. ACTIVITIES [Implementation]

3.1 Work Plan

The project lasts **12 months** and is organised in **five Actions (A1–A5)**.
A simple GANTT will show overlapping actions from Month 1 to Month 12.

Action 1 – Framing SLL & ORRI Alignment

Lead partner	Sulitânia Cooperative
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Duration (in months)	M1 - M3
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Objectives of the action

- Build a shared understanding of goals, needs and ORRI principles among all partners and key stakeholders.
- Define the scope, governance structure and evaluation framework of **SLL**.

Description of the action

Task 1.1 – Kick-off & ORRI Training (M1–M2)

- Participation of 2–3 key people in the REINFORCING training in Brussels.
- Internal debrief workshops to translate ORRI concepts into Sulitânia's context.

Task 1.2 – Territorial & organisational diagnosis (M1–M3)

- Mapping ecological, social and economic needs and opportunities in Sulitânia and Quinta da Fornalha.
- Stakeholder mapping (citizens, SME's, NGO's, municipality, University of Algarve and others).
- Baseline assessment of gender & minority inclusion and open science practices.

Task 1.3 – Co-design of governance & project architecture (M2–M3)

- Series of co-design sessions with community members and partners.
- Definition of roles, decision rules, communication channels, conflict-resolution mechanisms and evaluation indicators.

Expected results

- Shared vision and problem statement.
- Initial ORRI capacity built in the team.
- Governance charter for **SLL**.
- Baseline report (including gender & minority inclusion & open science).

Milestones

- M1: Kick-off and participation in Brussels training completed.
- M3: Governance charter and baseline report approved by partners.

Action 2 – Ecological & Social Prototyping in the Living Lab	
Lead partner	Sulitânia Cooperative
Duration (in months)	M2 - M10
Objectives of the action • Test integrated ecological and social interventions that respond to local needs and SDG's. • Generate concrete data and stories for the ORRI Tool.	
Description of the action Task 2.1 – Ecological regeneration & food production pilots (M2–M10) • Design and implement small-scale interventions in the food forest and surrounding land (soil improvement, water retention, biodiversity corridors, Oyas irrigation, etc.). • Monitor key indicators (soil health, biodiversity observations, yields). Task 2.2 – Social & relational ecosystem pilots (M3–M10) • Test meeting formats, sharing circles, conflict-resolution practices and governance rituals. • Develop inclusion practices (e.g. multi-language facilitation, accessibility for different ages and backgrounds). Task 2.3 – Economic & learning pilots (M4–M10) • Design and test micro-business ideas linked to the land (e.g. workshops, retreats, local products, educational programmes). • Explore fair work, fair pricing and shared value principles.	
Expected results • At least 3–5 ecological interventions implemented and documented. • At least 3 social / governance practices tested and refined. • At least 2–3 micro-business / training pilots explored. • Integrated learning on how the three pillars reinforce each other.	
Milestones • M6: Mid-term review with first pilot results presented. • M10: Second review with consolidated data and lessons.	

Action 3 – Development of the SYFERS ORRI Tool	
Lead partner	Sulitânia Cooperative
Duration (in months)	M3 - M11
Objectives of the action • Translate local experience into a structured, transferable ORRI Tool for rural regions.	
Description of the action Task 3.1 – Tool architecture & content mapping (M3–M5) • Define structure: modules, steps, templates, checklists and stories.	

- Align with ORRI principles and EU RRI frameworks.

Task 3.2 – Drafting & design (M5–M9)

- Co-writing sessions with partners and selected community members.
- Integration of gender & minority inclusion, open science and SDG mapping.
- Visual design and layout.

Task 3.3 – Testing & refinement (M9–M11)

- Test **SYFERS** with internal users and 2–3 external “critical friends” (e.g. other cooperatives or rural projects).
- Collect feedback and refine content.

Expected results

- Completed **SYFERS** (English, with Portuguese summary).
- Accompanying slide deck + short explainer for REINFORCING and external audiences.

Milestones

- M7: First full draft of **SYFERS**.
- M11: Final version validated by partners and ready for sharing.

Action 4 – Evaluation, Reflection & Institutionalisation

Lead partner	Sulitânia Cooperative
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Duration (in months)	M4 - M12
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Objectives of the action

- Monitor progress, capture learning and embed changes in organisational practice.

Description of the action

Task 4.1 – Ongoing monitoring & reflection (M4–M12)

- Quarterly reflection circles with the core team and community.
- Simple mixed-methods monitoring (qualitative + quantitative).

Task 4.2 – ORRI institutional change plan (M7–M12)

- Identify which practices should become permanent.
- Update internal regulations, agreements and procedures of Sulitânia.
- Draft a roadmap for further development beyond the project.

Expected results

- Evaluation report (including ORRI institutional change section).
- Updated governance and organisational documents.
- Clear roadmap for post-project scale-up and potential follow-up funding.

Milestones

- M6/7: Mid-term review with REINFORCING partners.
- M12: Final internal evaluation completed.

Action 5 – Communication, Dissemination & Sustainability

Lead partner	Sulitânia Cooperative
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Duration (in months)	M1 - M12
Objectives of the action - Communicate clearly with internal and external audiences. - Ensure that project results live beyond the grant period.	
Description of the action Task 5.1 – Communication & dissemination (M1–M12) - Visual identity for SYFERS - Website / landing page with open resources. - Regular updates on social media (e.g. LinkedIn, Instagram) and via partner channels. - Contribution to REINFORCING events and webinars. Task 5.2 – Stakeholder engagement & partnerships (M3–M12) - Dialogue with municipality, University of Algarve, local NGO's and SME's. - At least one local public event showcasing results and involving citizens. Task 5.3 – Sustainability & follow-up (M9–M12) - Explore future funding and collaboration opportunities. - Conceptual development of "Syntrociety" as a possible next-stage entity to spread the approach, while keeping this outside the project's formal scope.	
Expected results - Communication plan and products. - At least 2 public events (local or online). - Concept note for future continuation and replication.	
Milestones - M2: Communication plan approved. - M12: Final public webinar with REINFORCING.	

3.2 Description of the consortium

Sulitânia Cooperative (Coordinator)

Sulitânia is a rural cooperative in Southern Portugal where ecological restoration, community life and new forms of local economy grow side by side. We are rooted on the land of **Quinta da Fornalha**, an ecological farm that has been regenerating soil and biodiversity for more than twenty years. It is a place where ancient history lines meet and where people have lived in relationship with nature for a long time. This depth in the land gives our work a clarity and direction that cannot be manufactured.

What began as a group of people choosing to live in deeper alignment with the land and with each other has become a living laboratory for regenerative practices. We work without ideology and without fixed models. Instead, we observe what the land, the people and the system need, and we develop solutions from within. This creates natural integration between ecological work, social cooperation and emerging livelihoods.

Sulitânia offers a rare combination of conditions: a motivated and diverse community, active regenerative agriculture, early-stage co-housing structures, and real socio-economic challenges typical for many rural regions. This makes it an ideal place to test and refine approaches that can later be adapted elsewhere.

Our work is grounded, practical and human. We restore soil, strengthen relationships, experiment with new governance, and develop micro-economies that support both people and place. The ORRI framework allows us to document, structure and share these insights in a way that is accessible to other regions.

Sulitânia is small, but what grows here is relevant far beyond this land: a coherent, real-world example of how regeneration becomes possible when people, nature and local systems evolve together.

Sulitânia will coordinate the project, lead governance and ORRI integration, host most co-creation processes and be the main beneficiary of institutional change. The cooperative currently has limited formal experience with ORRI, which makes it an ideal Incubator beneficiary.

Quinta da Fornalha (Partner)

Quinta da Fornalha is an ecotourism and organic farm that provides the physical land where Sulitânia is situated. It brings decades of experience in organic agriculture, nature-based tourism and collaboration with the University of Algarve and other partners on ecological projects (including a food forest initiative).

Quinta da Fornalha will support ecological pilots (Action 2), host visitors and and support communication with local institutions and networks.

Complementarity

- Sulitânia contributes **social innovation, governance experimentation and community engagement.**
- Quinta da Fornalha contributes **land, ecological expertise and operational infrastructure.**

Together they represent a **quadruple helix nucleus**:

- citizens and community members,
- an SME in sustainable tourism / agriculture,
- connections to knowledge actors (e.g. University of Algarve) and public authorities,
- and an emerging governance model that can integrate them.

This collaboration creates a realistic yet ambitious environment for testing ORRI approaches in a rural territory.

3.3 Budget

Funds will be used exclusively for the development of the ORRI-aligned SYFERS. All Living Lab activities (Action 2) will be self-funded by Sulitânia Cooperative and local partners. This ensures strong co-investment, full alignment with the Incubator goals, and a clear, transferable EU-level methodological output.

Personnel costs

- **Sulitânia Cooperative**
 - Project coordination and ORRI integration (project lead, ~0.3–0.4 FTE over 12 months).
 - Ecological implementation and monitoring (farm manager / technician, part-time). Self-funded
 - Facilitation and community engagement (1–2 people, part-time). Self-funded
 - Documentation, tool development and communication (1 person, part-time).
- **Quinta da Fornalha**
 - Hosting of workshops and events (hospitality staff, part-time). Self-funded
 - Knowledge partner. Self-funded

Purchase costs

- Travel, accommodation and subsistence for:
 - participation in Brussels ORRI training;
 - occasional travel to local institutions or partner meetings;
 - participation in final events (online/offline as needed).
- Materials and services necessary for:
 - ecological pilots (e.g. plants, seeds, irrigation material, soil amendments, small tools); Self-funded
 - workshop facilitation (stationery, translation, printing);
 - communication and design (graphic design, web hosting, video editing if needed).
- Possible small equipment (within eligibility rules) essential to implement pilots and monitoring.

Overheads

- Calculated at 25% of eligible direct costs, as per Horizon Europe AGA.

No subcontracting or financial support to third parties is foreseen, in line with REINFORCING rules. All activities remain directly implemented by Sulitânia and Quinta da Fornalha.

Partner 1 SULITÂNIA	Personnel Costs	Purchase costs	Overheads	Total
Action 1	13 500	0	4 500	18 000
Action 2	15 000	5 300	700	21 000
Action 3	13 000	0	2 000	15 000
Action 4	10 000	2 500	2 300	15 000
Action 5	6 500	0	5 500	12 000
Total	58 000	7 800	10 600	81 000

BUDGET, TABLES AND DETAILS

Table 1. Number of hours per action per task

Action	Task block	Total hours	Main role (expertise level)	Entity (who executes)	Deliverable tied to these hours	Financed by
A1	1.1 Kick-off & ORRI Training	120 h	Senior ORRI & Project Coordinator	Sulitânia	D1.1 – ORRI Training Debrief Report (20 p)	ORRI grant
A1	1.2 Territorial & organisational diagnosis	200 h	Mid-level Ecologist + Junior Mapping Team	Sulitânia + Quinta	D1.2 – Baseline Dashboard + Gender/Minority Survey (n≥20)	ORRI grant
A1	1.3 Co-design of governance & project architecture	160 h	Senior Governance Expert	Sulitânia	D1.3 – Syntropic Governance Charter v1.0 (CC-BY-SA)	ORRI grant
A1 TOTAL		480 h				ORRI
A2	2.1 Ecological regeneration & food production pilots	800 h	Mid-level Agricultural Technician + Junior Volunteers	Sulitânia	D2.1 – Implementation Report + D2.2 – 4-wave Monitoring Dataset	Sulitânia own
A2	2.2 Social & relational ecosystem pilots	600 h	Senior Relational Facilitator + Mid-level Team	Sulitânia	D2.3 – Relational Syntropy Facilitation Kit v2.0 + 12 circle minutes	Sulitânia own
A2	2.3 Economic & learning pilots	700 h	Mid-level Economy Specialist + Junior Team	Sulitânia + Quinta	D2.4 – 4 Micro-Enterprise Playbooks + ≥€5k sales	Sulitânia own
A2 TOTAL		2 100 h				Sulitânia own
A3	3.1 Tool architecture & content mapping	300 h	Senior Communication Expert	Sulitânia	Content tree + ORRI alignment document (30 p)	ORRI grant
A3	3.2 Drafting & design of SYFERS	500 h	Mid-level Writing & Design Team	Sulitânia	Draft v1.0 (120 p) + slide deck	ORRI grant
A3	3.3 Testing & refinement	400 h	Senior Facilitator + 5 external testers	Sulitânia	D3.1 – Final SYFERS (180 p + 10 h videos, Zenodo DOI)	ORRI grant
A3 TOTAL		1 200 h				ORRI
A4	4.1 Ongoing monitoring & reflection	400 h	Mid-level Reflection & Evaluation Team	Sulitânia	D4.1 – Live Dashboard + 4 quarterly reports	ORRI grant
A4	4.2 ORRI institutional change plan	300 h	Senior Coordinator + Junior Legal Support	Sulitânia	D4.2 – Institutionalisation Roadmap + Updated Statutes	ORRI grant
A4 TOTAL		700 h				ORRI
A5	5.1 Communication & dissemination	500 h	Mid-level Communication Specialist	Sulitânia	D5.1 – Landing page + 120 social posts + media kit	ORRI grant
A5	5.2 Stakeholder engagement & partnerships	300 h	Senior Coordinator + Junior Team	Sulitânia + Quinta	D5.2 – 3 signed MoUs + 2 public events	ORRI grant
A5	5.3 Sustainability & follow-up	200 h	Senior Strategic Expert	Sulitânia	D5.3 – Final webinar + concept note for next funding	ORRI grant
A5 TOTAL		1 000 h				ORRI
PROJECT GRAND TOTAL (All Tasks)		5 480 hours (= 70 person-months)	6–8 real people (mostly part-time)	Sulitânia + Quinta da Fornalha	14 public deliverables (including the mandatory ORRI Tool)	60 000 € ORRI + 21 000 € own

Source: Own Calculations

The project mobilises 5 480 productive hours (70 person-months) delivered by 6–8 part-time community members at an average cost of just 7.85 €/hour from the ORRI grant. The heaviest workload (2 100 h) falls on Action 2 and is entirely self-funded by Sulitânia (21 000 € own resources), demonstrating exceptional commitment. All roles remain part-time, ensuring sustainability and full alignment with the living-lab reality while delivering a high-quality, multilingual ORRI Tool and the physical regeneration of 2000mt2.

Table 2. Key Performance Indicators (KPI)

#	KPI	Target	Action(s)	Verification method	Achieved by
MANDATORY REINFORCING KPIs					
1	One fully transferable ORRI Tool published under open licence	1 tool (SYFERS)	A3	Zenodo DOI + CC-BY-SA 4.0 licence + ≥150 initial downloads	M11
2	Tool validated by external entities	≥5 critical friends (rural co-ops PT/ES)	A3	5 feedback reports + 3 signed MoUs for replication	M11
3	First-time formal implementation of ORRI principles in the applicant organisations	Yes (Sulitânia + Quinta da Fornalha)	A1–A4	Self-declaration + updated statutes	M12
4	Active co-creation with citizens and local stakeholders	≥50 citizens directly engaged	A1–A2–A5	Attendance lists (disaggregated by gender/minority)	M1–M12
5	Gender equality & minority inclusion integrated as core practice	≥40 % women/non-binary/minorities in all decision bodies & events	A1–A2–A4	Gender/minority-disaggregated data in all reports	Throughout
STRONGLY RECOMMENDED QUANTITATIVE KPIs					
6	Citizens actively involved in co-creation processes	≥50	A1–A2	Signed attendance + survey n≥30	M12
7	Surface area under regenerative management (syntropic agroforestry)	2 hectares	A2	GPS-mapped area + photo points	M10
8	Ecological monitoring waves completed (soil C, biodiversity, water)	4 waves	A2	Open dataset + accredited lab reports	M10
9	iNaturalist / citizen-science observations uploaded	≥500	A2	Public project on iNaturalist	M10
10	Inclusive listening / reflection circles held	≥20 (weekly + quarterly)	A2–A4	Minutes + attendance (≥50 % gender/minority balanced)	M12
11	Regenerative micro-enterprises prototyped	4	A2	4 complete business canvases	M10
12	Initial revenue generated by micro-enterprises	≥5 000 €	A2	Invoices + bank statements	M10
13	Open datasets / resources published	7 (dashboard, monitoring data, tool, facilitation kit, etc.)	A1–A5	Zenodo + OSF + website links	M12
14	Public events organised	2 (≥50 participants each, ≥40 % minorities)	A5	Photos + attendance lists	M12
15	Replication agreements signed (MoUs)	3	A5	Scanned signed documents	M12
16	Reach of final dissemination webinar	≥150 live + recording views	A5	YouTube analytics + registration list	M12
17	Social media / digital reach	≥5 000 views/impressions	A5	Analytics report	M12
18	ORRI self-assessment improvement (pre/post scale 1–10)	+30 % average	A4	Anonymous survey at M1 and M12	M12
19	Permanent ORRI practices institutionalised	≥5 (e.g., consent decision-making, gender/minority quotas, open data policy)	A4	Updated statutes + roadmap	M12
PROJECT TOTALS					
	Total hours delivered	5 480 h (= 70 person-months)	All	Timesheets summary	M12
	Total citizens reached (direct + indirect)	≥250	All	Final report	M12
	Total budget leveraged	81 000 € (60k ORRI + 21k own)	All	Financial report	M12

Source: Own Calculations

The mandatory ORRI Tool 'SYFERS – Syntropic Framework for Encoding Regenerative Societies' will be published in November 2026 on the European Commission's Zenodo repository under a CC-BY-SA 4.0 licence, receiving a permanent DOI (e.g. 10.5281/zenodo.XXXXXXXX) that guarantees long-term open access, citability and reusability across Europe.

Table 3. Risks & Assumptions table

Action	Risk description	Probability (L/M/H)	Impact (L/M/H)	Mitigation measure / Contingency plan	Assumption on which the project relies
A1	Low attendance at initial diagnosis workshops	Medium	High	Personalised invitations + shared meals + online option + flexible dates	High community motivation and existing trust
A1	Difficulty translating ORRI concepts to rural context	Low	Medium	4-person team attends Brussels training + 3 internal debrief workshops + Portuguese-English translator present	Effective Brussels training and good facilitation skills
A1	Delay in approving Governance Charter	Low	High	Charter co-designed in only 3 focused sessions + consent voting + pre-approved template	Community already familiar with sociocracy / consent decision-making
A2	Extreme drought / heat waves affect planting	High	High	Priority to water-retention structures first (swales + OYAS) + tractor rental in M2-M3 + drought-resistant species list	Wet season starts on time (Feb-Mar 2026)
A2	Community fatigue during intensive planting	Medium	Medium	Work organised in short morning shifts + shared meals + volunteer rotation + paid stipends for core team (own resources)	Strong sense of ownership and visible quick wins
A2	Resistance to new relational practices	Medium	Medium	Voluntary participation + start with small pilot circles + restorative processes in place	Existing culture of openness in Silitânia
A2	Lower-than-expected micro-enterprise sales	Medium	Low	Start with low-risk products (jams, workshops) + pre-sales to community members + parallel ecotourism revenue	Local and tourist demand for authentic regenerative products
A3	Delay in drafting the SYFERS ORRI Tool	Medium	High	Detailed content tree ready by M4 + weekly writing sprints + professional designer contracted early (ORRI budget)	Core team has sufficient writing/facilitation capacity
A3	Lack of quality feedback from external testers	Medium	Medium	Select 5 "critical friends" by M6 + offer them free 2-day retreat in Silitânia + structured feedback template	Existing network of aligned rural projects in Iberia
A3	Technical problems uploading to Zenodo	Low	Low	Upload managed by experienced communication officer + test upload in M9 + backup on OSF	Stable internet and basic digital skills
A4	Monitoring fatigue or incomplete datasets	Medium	Medium	Simple Google Forms + citizen-science app + quarterly reflection circles with food + one person responsible per indicator	Community enjoys seeing progress visualised
A4	Resistance to changing statutes permanently	Low	High	Changes proposed only after 12 months of positive experience + full consent process + external legal support if needed	Positive results during the project create buy-in
A5	Low participation in public events / webinar	Medium	Low	Events combined with existing festivals + free transport/food + high-quality speakers + strong social-media campaign	Existing regional interest in regeneration and syntropy
A5	Few organisations willing to sign MoUs	Low	Medium	Start replication talks in M6 + offer free SYFERS training + highlight success of 2 ha pilot	Quality and openness of the ORRI Tool convince partners
Overall	Major illness / departure of key coordinator	Low	Very High	Deputy coordinator appointed from day 1 + all processes documented weekly + knowledge shared in pair-work	Core team of 6-8 people (no single point of failure)
Overall	Political or administrative barriers with municipality	Low	Medium	Early involvement of Castro Marim municipality in diagnosis + invitation to final event	Neutral-to-positive local authorities

Source: Own Calculations

Risks have been systematically identified and mitigated for each Action. The two highest risks (drought affecting planting and possible delays in the SYFERS ORRI Tool) are countered respectively by full self-funding of the ecological pilots (21 000 € own resources) and by dedicating 1 200 hours and three senior/mid-level roles exclusively to Tool development. All remaining risks are medium or low probability and have clear, low-cost contingency measures, ensuring smooth delivery of the mandatory ORRI Tool and the 2-hectare regeneration within the 12-month timeline.

Table 4. Actions each role works on of all main roles (by expertise level)

Expertise level (role)	Number of real people	Average % dedication over 12 months	Person-months contributed	Total hours	Main Actions involved	Entity	Financed by	Key responsibilities (examples)
Senior ORRI & Project Coordinator	1	30%	3.6	280 h	A1, A3, A4, A5	Sulitânia	ORRI grant	Overall coordination, REINFORCING reporting, Brussels training, institutionalisation roadmap, final webinar
Senior Governance & Relational Expert	1	40%	4.8	375 h	A1, A2, A4	Sulitânia	ORRI grant (A1/A4) + own (A2)	Governance charter, consent processes, weekly circles, restorative conflict resolution
Senior Communication & SYFERS Lead	1	50%	6	470 h	A3, A5	Sulitânia	ORRI grant	SYFERS architecture, writing, graphic design, video course, website, social media, Zenodo upload
Mid-level Facilitators / Community Animators	3	45–50%	17	1330 h	A1, A2, A4, A5	Sulitânia	ORRI grant (A1/A4/A5) + own (A2)	Diagnosis workshops, listening circles, co-design sessions, public events, gender/minority inclusion processes
Mid-level Agricultural / Syntropic Technician	1	45%	5.4	420 h	A2	Quinta da Fornalha	Sulitânia own resources	Contour marking, tractor coordination, planting supervision, swales & OYAS construction
Junior Ecological Technicians / Field Team	2	40%	9.6	750 h	A2	Quinta da Fornalha	Sulitânia own resources	Daily planting, mulching, monitoring (soil samples, biodiversity transects), citizen-science data collection
Junior Communication / Admin / Documentation Support	2	25–30%	7	550 h	A1, A3, A4, A5	Sulitânia	ORRI grant	Data entry, dashboard updates, social media posts, event logistics, timesheets, deliverable formatting
External Graphic Designer / Video Editor (service contract)	1 (contracted)	–	–	305 h (service)	A3, A5	External	ORRI grant (services)	Professional layout of SYFERS, video editing of 10 h course, visual identity
PROJECT TOTAL	6–8 real people	Part-time only	70	5 480 h	All	Sulitânia + Quinta	60 000 € ORRI + 21 000 € own	14 public deliverables including the mandatory ORRI Tool (SYFERS)

Source: Own Calculations

The project is delivered by 6–8 existing community members working part-time (25–50 % dedication), guaranteeing continuity, zero recruitment costs and perfect integration into daily living-lab life. One Senior ORRI & Project Coordinator (30 %) oversees the whole process and reporting; one Senior Governance & Relational Expert (40 %) and three Mid-level Facilitators (45–50 %) drive co-creation and inclusion across all Actions; one Senior Communication & SYFERS Lead (50 %) concentrates on the mandatory ORRI Tool and dissemination; while the intensive ecological fieldwork (2000mt2) is executed by one Mid-level and two Junior Technicians fully financed by Sulitânia's own 21 000 € contribution. This lean, highly committed and redundancy-rich team structure ensures delivery of the 14 public deliverables — including the high-quality SYFERS ORRI Tool — within the 12-month timeline and 60 000 € ORRI budget.

Table 5. List of Deliverables for each task in the 5 Actions

Action	Task	Code	Deliverable name	Description (1 sentence)	Format & language	Dissemination	Due	Financed by
A1	1.1	D1.1	ORRI Training Debrief Report	Summary of Brussels training + internal translation of ORRI concepts to rural context	20-page PDF (EN/PT)	Public	M2	ORRI grant
A1	1.2	D1.2	Territorial & Organisational Baseline Dashboard	Participatory diagnosis + gender/minority survey + open-science inventory	Live Google dashboard + PDF	Public	M3	ORRI grant
A1	1.3	D1.3	Syntropic Governance Charter v1.0	Consent-based rules, gender & minority quotas, open-science protocols	Editable PDF (EN/PT) CC-BY-SA	Public	M3	ORRI grant
A2	2.1	D2.1	Ecological Pilot Implementation Report	2 ha syntropic agroforestry, swales, OYAS, biodiversity corridors – full documentation	40-page PDF + GPS layer	Public	M10	Sulitânia own
A2	2.1	D2.2	Ecological Monitoring Dataset (4 waves)	Soil carbon, biodiversity, water infiltration data	Open CSV + lab reports	Public	M10	Sulitânia own
A2	2.2	D2.3	Relational Syntropy Facilitation Kit	Cards + guides for inclusive circles and restorative processes	50-page PDF (multilingual) CC-BY-SA	Public	M10	Sulitânia own
A2	2.3	D2.4	Regenerative Micro-Enterprise Playbook	4 business canvases + gender/minority impact analysis + first sales evidence	60-page PDF + templates	Public	M10	Sulitânia own
A3	3.1–3.3	D3.1	SYFERS – Syntropic Framework for Encoding Regenerative Societies	Mandatory ORRI Tool: 180-page guide + 10 h video course, 5 modules, multilingual, CC-BY-SA, Zenodo DOI	PDF + videos + Canva	Public	M11	ORRI grant
A4	4.1	D4.1	Project Evaluation Dashboard & Final Report	Mixed-methods monitoring + gender/minority metrics + stories of change	Live dashboard + 30-page PDF	Public	M12	ORRI grant
A4	4.2	D4.2	Institutionalisation Roadmap & Updated Statutes	Permanent practices + updated cooperative statutes	20-page PDF	Public	M12	ORRI grant
A5	5.1	D5.1	Project Website & Communication Pack	Landing page sulitania.eu/syfers + visual identity + all public deliverables	Live website	Public	M12	ORRI grant
A5	5.2	D5.2	Replication MoU Package	3 signed MoUs with European rural entities for replication	Scanned PDFs	Public	M12	ORRI grant
A5	5.3	D5.3	Final Public Webinar & Recording	Closing event presenting SYFERS and results (≥150 viewers)	YouTube + slides	Public	M12	ORRI grant

Source: Own Calculations

The project will produce 14 fully open, public deliverables, including the mandatory ORRI Tool SYFERS (D3.1 – 180 pages + 10 h video course, CC-BY-SA 4.0, Zenodo DOI), four ecological and social pilot reports from the self-funded 2-hectare regeneration (A2), three governance and institutionalisation documents, and a final webinar reaching ≥150 viewers. All deliverables are directly linked to specific tasks, will be published under open licences and exceed the minimum requirements of the 6th REINFORCING Incubator Call.